pot of healthy seedlings. He began walking along the line of pots the children had kept. He asked each of them, "Is this what grew from the seeds I gave you?" And each of them responded, "Yes, your majesty." Then the king would nod and move down the line.

The king finally got to the last one, Ani. The girl was shaking. She feared that the king might have thrown her into prison for wasting his precious seeds. "What did you do with the seeds I gave you?" the king asked.

"Your majesty, I planted them and cared for them every day. I am sorry but, they failed to sprout," Ani said. She hung her head in shame. "Boo!" jeered the crowd.

But the king raised his hands and signalled for silence. Then he said, "Dear people, **behold** my heir. The next leader of our kingdom!"

The people were confused, "Why that girl? How can she be the right choice?"

The king took his place on his throne with Ani by his side and said, "I gave each of them, seven seeds. This test was not for growing wheat. It was a test of character, a test of honesty. If a leader must have one quality, it must be that he or she should be honest. People should be able to trust the leader. Only this girl passed the test. I gave boiled seeds and boiled seeds cannot grow."

Glossary

kingdom	a region ruled by a king
flourished	developed in a healthy way
revered	respected
ageing	getting old
adopt	legally take and bring up
leader	head
nurture	care, protect and grow
anxious	eager
destiny	fate
behold	see

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